DRAFT: for legal review, not yet in force

Zero Cube Chapter Charter

Starting Zero Cube in your country: an open-source, people's movement model

Draft version 0.1 · 24 October 2026 · For discussion with our Company Secretary, Chartered Accountant and lawyer

Status. This is a draft for discussion only. It is not in force, creates no legal rights or obligations, and is not an offer. No country chapters exist yet; we are inviting the first founding teams. Points marked "CS/CA / lawyer to confirm" must be reviewed before anyone signs.

1. Purpose

1.1 **Two main goals, as equals.** Zero Cube has two main goals: Net Zero and climate action, and accessible, quality education for every child. Climate change and unequal education do not stop at borders. Country chapters let people everywhere use and spread Zero Cube's open frameworks for both goals, in their own language and context.

1.2 **Unconditional for every child.** Access to education for children is unconditional: no fees, no marks or merit cut-offs, and no conditions of income, caste, religion, gender, disability, language, location or nationality. Inequality begins when access has conditions, so ours has none. Frameworks and certification criteria apply to institutions (schools, colleges, companies), never to children.

1.3 **Our spirit.** We are guided by वसुधैव कुटुम्बकम् (Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam): the world is one family. Zero Cube is *from the people, for the people*: everyone stands at the same level, and titles are responsibilities, not ranks.

1.4 **SDG alignment.** Chapter work is designed to align with the UN Sustainable Development Goals, especially SDG 4 (quality education) and SDG 13 (climate action). Alignment is all we claim: Zero Cube and its chapters are not endorsed by, affiliated with or speaking for the United Nations, and must not use the UN emblem.

2. The chapter model

2.1 **Independent entities.** Each chapter is its own independent not-for-profit legal entity, registered under the laws of its own country, and named "Zero Cube [Country]" (for example, "Zero Cube Kenya"). One chapter per country, unless the Global Council agrees otherwise.

2.2 **No ownership, control or funding.** Zero Cube Climate & Social Impact Foundation (India; a not-for-profit company licensed under Section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013; CIN U88900PN2026NPL260913) ("Zero Cube India") does not own, control or fund any chapter, and no chapter funds Zero Cube India.

2.3 **No money flows either way.** There are no charter fees, membership fees between entities, royalties, licence fees, revenue shares or transfers of funds in either direction. Each chapter raises and spends its own money under its own laws, and Zero Cube India does the same in India.

2.4 **No agency.** Neither party is the agent, partner, branch or representative of the other, and neither can sign, borrow or speak for the other. Each is responsible for its own staff, volunteers, contracts, taxes, filings and liabilities.

CS/CA / lawyer to confirm: *Indian FCRA and income-tax position (including that no foreign contribution is received and no funds are sent abroad), the Section 8 objects and any Board/RoC approvals needed for this arrangement; equivalent rules in each chapter's country.*

3. Licences

3.1 **Open frameworks.** Zero Cube's published frameworks, criteria, methodologies and course materials are released under the Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International licence (CC BY-SA 4.0). Anyone may use, adapt and share them, chapter or not, provided they give credit and share adaptations under the same licence. Using the frameworks does not entitle anyone to use the Zero Cube name or to issue Zero Cube certificates.

3.2 **Name and marks.** The name "Zero Cube", the Zero Cube logos and the "Zero Cube Certified" mark (the "Marks") are licensed free of charge, non-exclusively and revocably, only to chartered chapters, only within their own country and only for activities that follow this Charter and the brand guidelines.

3.3 **Trademarks.** Registration of the Marks is planned: in India first, and later internationally through the Madrid Protocol. Until registration, the Marks are used under this licence and the parties' goodwill. Chapters must not register the Marks, or any similar name, domain or social-media handle, in their own name without written consent, and will transfer any such registrations on request.

CS/CA / lawyer to confirm: *trademark filing status and classes, Madrid Protocol timing, CC BY-SA 4.0 suitability for each framework, and protection of the "Zero Cube Certified" mark (certification mark or collective mark).*

4. Chapter commitments

4.1 **Education access for children is unconditional.** No child is ever charged, selected, screened or turned away to learn: no fees, no marks or merit cut-offs, no conditions. Any membership for students is optional and never a condition of learning.

4.2 **Not-for-profit.** Stay not-for-profit at all times: no dividends or distribution of surplus to founders, members or directors.

4.3 **One framework version.** Follow the current official version of the frameworks and the certification standard, and say which version was used.

4.4 **No crypto.** Do not use, accept, issue or promote cryptocurrencies, tokens or similar crypto-assets in Zero Cube's name.

4.5 **Villages and communities never pay.** Villages and local communities never pay for certification; their journeys are funded by others, such as CSR or philanthropy.

4.6 **Honest claims.** Never invent claims, statistics, results, testimonials or partners. Name a partner only after a written agreement is signed.

4.7 **Transparency.** Publish an annual report each year covering activities, certifications and finances (income received and how it was applied).

4.8 **Conflicts of interest.** Every founder, board member, assessor and reviewer signs a conflict-of-interest declaration every year, and steps out of any decision where they have an interest.

4.9 **Safeguarding.** Have a written safeguarding and child-protection policy for all education work, with consent from schools and parents and a named safeguarding lead.

4.10 **Data privacy.** Collect only the personal data needed, with consent, and follow the data-protection law of the chapter's country.

4.11 **Neutrality.** Stay politically and religiously neutral: no support for parties, candidates or religious causes in Zero Cube's name.

4.12 **No commercial promotion.** Never use the Zero Cube name or Marks to promote, sell or endorse any commercial product or business, including those of founders or their families.

5. Certification integrity: one global standard

5.1 **Steward.** Zero Cube India is the steward of the frameworks and of the certification standard, so that a Zero Cube certificate means the same thing everywhere.

5.2 **What chapters may do.** Chapters may run awareness work, courses, training and assessments under the frameworks.

5.3 **How certificates are issued.** A Zero Cube certificate is issued only after (a) an assessment against the shared criteria and (b) an independent peer review by trained reviewers who had no part in the project and have no conflict of interest. Every certificate is listed in a public register showing its criteria version, scope and validity.

5.4 **Separation.** Nobody may assess or review a project they designed, delivered, funded or advised. Fees, membership or sponsorship never buy a certificate.

5.5 **What certificates are not.** Zero Cube certificates are programme certificates under our own published criteria. They are not government licences, accreditation or carbon credits, and must never be presented as such.

6. Governance

6.1 **Global Council.** Chartered chapters and Zero Cube India form a Global Council, with one equal voice per chapter. Everyone sits at the same level; titles are responsibilities, not ranks. The Council meets at least once a year, online, and keeps public minutes.

6.2 **Changing the frameworks.** Anyone may propose a change. Proposals are published openly for public comment for a reasonable period. The steward then approves, amends or declines the change, gives its reasons in writing and publishes the new version with a date and version number.

6.3 **Advisory role.** The Global Council advises on the Charter, the frameworks and chapter matters. It does not manage, fund or direct any chapter or Zero Cube India, which each remain governed by their own boards and laws.

CS/CA / lawyer to confirm: *how the Council is constituted without creating a partnership, association or unincorporated body in law; the steward's decision rights.*

7. Joining steps

7.1 **Expression of interest.** The founding team writes to us (website form or zerocubecif@gmail.com).

7.2 **Introductory call.** We meet online to share the vision, the Charter and what the work involves.

7.3 **Founding team due diligence.** At least three founders, with no conflicts of interest (including no commercial interest in Zero Cube's work), identity checks and references.

7.4 **Legal registration.** The team registers a not-for-profit legal entity in its own country.

7.5 **Signing the Charter.** The new entity and Zero Cube India sign this Charter.

7.6 **Six-month pilot.** The chapter runs a pilot with agreed, modest goals, and uses the name as "Zero Cube [Country] (pilot)".

7.7 **Full charter.** After a successful review of the pilot, the chapter becomes fully chartered and joins the Global Council.

8. Review, suspension and withdrawal

8.1 **Annual review.** Each chapter's compliance with this Charter is reviewed once a year, based on its annual report and certificate register.

8.2 **Concerns and suspension.** If a serious breach is suspected, the chapter is told in writing and given a fair chance to respond and put things right, usually within 30 days. If the breach is not remedied, or is severe (for example fraud, safeguarding failures or false claims), Zero Cube India may suspend the right to issue certificates and use the Marks.

8.3 **Withdrawal of the name.** If a breach continues, the licence to use the Marks may be withdrawn. The chapter must then stop using the Marks within 30 days, change its name, and hand over or close any domains, accounts and registrations using the Marks. Certificates already issued stay in the public register, marked with their status.

8.4 **Exit.** Either party may end this Charter with 90 days' written notice, with no penalty and no payment either way. The same name-transition steps apply. The CC BY-SA licence to the frameworks continues for everyone, as it always does.

8.5 **Governing law and disputes.** This Charter is governed by the laws of India. The parties will first try to settle any dispute by good-faith discussion and mediation.

CS/CA / lawyer to confirm: *governing law and forum (and whether to use arbitration, seat and rules), enforceability in each chapter's country, notice periods, and liability limits.*

Signatures

For Zero Cube Climate & Social Impact Foundation (India)

Name: _____

Designation: Director _____

Signature: _____

Date and place: _____

For Zero Cube [Country]

Legal name of entity: _____

Registration no.: _____

Authorised representative: _____

Designation: _____

Signature: _____

Date and place: _____